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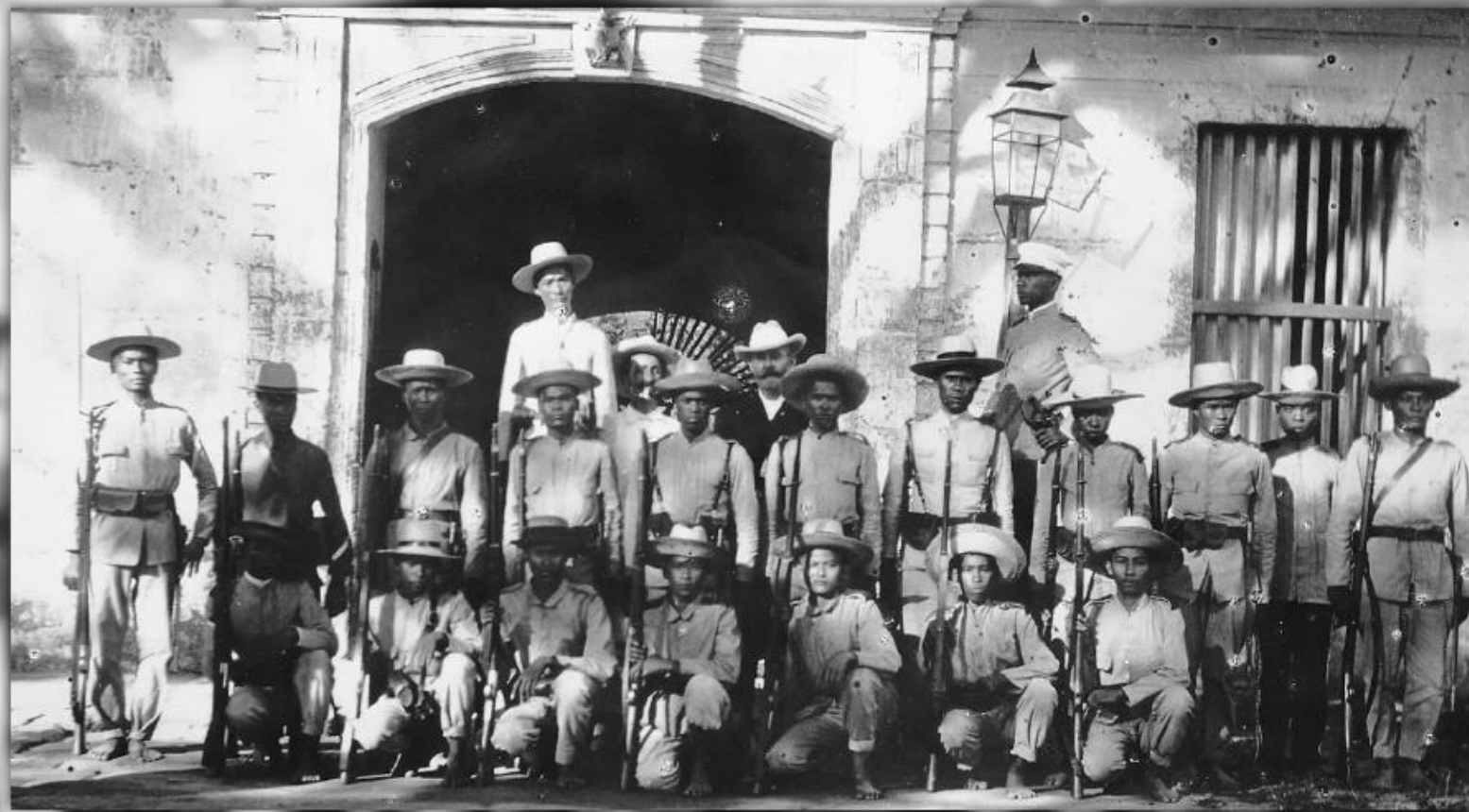
Rizal's Life and Works

Fundamental Concept p.1

Cedar Jan G. Agua, LPT, MAEd-TSS







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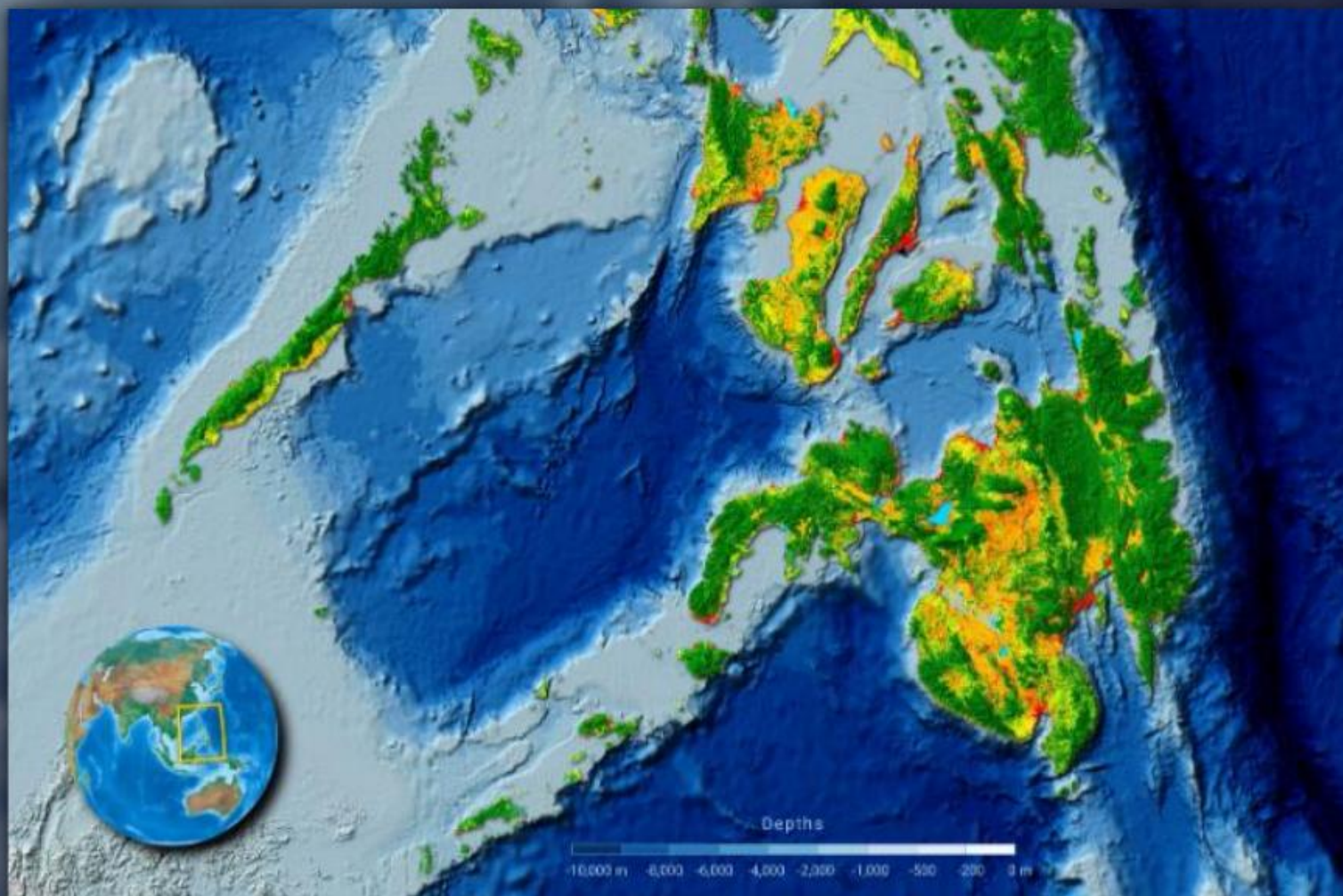
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LANDCOVER of the PHILIPPINES

(ESRI, 2020)







JOSÉ RIZAL'S
— FULL NAME —
**JOSÉ PROTASIO
RIZAL MERCADO
Y ALONSO REALONDA**

José Rizal

*Calamba, Laguna
June 19, 1861*



PARTIDA DE NACIMIENTO

José Protasio Rizal Mercado y Alonso Realonda

nació el día 19 de Junio de 1861

en Calamba, Laguna, Filipinas.

Padres: Francisco Mercado y Teodora Alonso Realonda.

Padrinos: José Patricio y Micaela Tan.

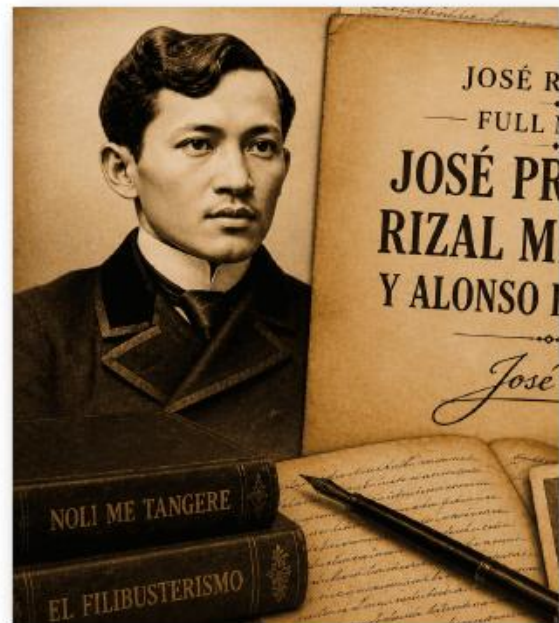


NOLI ME TANGERE

EL FILIBUSTERISMO

Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

- **Legal Mandate** – Required by **RA 1425 (1956)** to teach nationalism, patriotism, and civic duty.
- **Mirror of Our Society** – His writings expose the same problems of abuse, corruption, inequality, lack of education, and foreign control.
- **Build National Identity** – Defines what it means to be Filipino; fights colonial mentality and foreign dependence.



Note: He believed **knowledge and reason** are the best weapons for change, not just reforms.

**MAKE THE REAL
CULPRITS PAY!**

GREENPEACE

**STOP
THE
GREED**

**CORRUPTION
KILLS!**

GREENPEACE

**I'm not a FAN
of corruption**

GREENPEACE

**STOP
THE
GREED**

**I'm not a FAN
of corruption**

TIME TO RESIST

COLLUSION, CORRUPTION, IMPUNITY & GREED

WE WILL
NOT
BE
SILENT

INJUSTICE
ANYWHERE
IS A THREAT TO
JUSTICE
EVERYWHERE

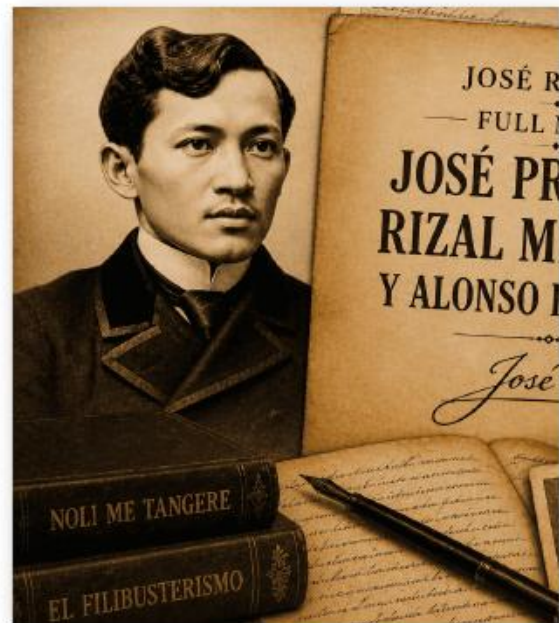
ALL
LIVES
MATTER

Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

The **Republic Act 1425 (Rizal Law)** emphasized its purpose to instill nationalism and patriotism, yet it is often criticized as ineffective seen in how many people still mistakenly greet Rizal "Happy Birthday" on his death anniversary.

It details the **law's origin:**

- Filed April 3, 1956 as **Senate Bill 438** by **Senator Claro M. Recto**, sponsored by **Senator Jose P. Laurel**.
- Sparked intense, weeks-long debates in the **Senate starting April 23, 1956.**





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Senator Claro M. Recto authored the **Rizal Law (Republic Act 1425)** in **1956**.

It mandates the **compulsory study** of José Rizal's life, works, and writings (specifically *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*) in all **public and private schools, colleges, and universities** to foster Filipino nationalism.

Key proponents: Recto & Laurel

Main opponents: Senators Francisco Rodrigo, Decoroso Rosales, Mariano Cuenco.





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Controversy spread to society

- The **Catholic Church** (led by Archbishop Manuel Yap) threatened to close churches if the bill passed; Recto publicly responded that **government should manage parishes.**

Supporters included **Manila Mayor Arsenio Lacson** and former President **Emilio Aguinaldo.**





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

To resolve deadlock, **Laurel amended the bill:**

- Expanded coverage to include **all Rizal's works**, not just *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*.
- Removed the requirement for **unexpurgated (uncensored)** editions, but kept study of them for college students.
- Added exemptions for students if reading such works would **harm their faith**.

Note: The amended version was approved **May 17, 1956**, signed by **President Ramon Magsaysay (7th)** June 12, 1956, and became **Republic Act 1425**.



Debate

ARGUMENT

Difference of Opinion

Controversy

Contention

DISAGREEMENT

DISSENT

Public Dispute



Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Why so controversial?

- Rizal was elevated above other heroes.
- His novels were seen as **anti-friar and anti-Catholic**: *Noli Me Tangere* (333 pages) – only 25 pages about nationalism, but 120 against the Church, 170 against Catholic faith; *El Filibusterismo* adds 50 more critical pages.

Note: Opponents **argued this violated religious freedom** and the **1935 Constitution**.





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Why so controversial?

- The **controversy** went beyond lawmakers: the **Catholic Church** campaigned aggressively against the bill, threatening to close parishes if it became law. Supporters like **Senator Recto** openly **countered that the government**, not the Church, should run public affairs.

Note: Prominent backers included **Manila Mayor Arsenio Lacson** and former **President Emilio Aguinaldo**.





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

- **Senator Rodrigo** wanted this requirement removed entirely;
- **Senator Lim** suggested exemptions for students whose **faith might be harmed**; and
- **Senator Primicias** insisted the **texts remain part of learning materials**.

Note: The law mandates that ***Noli Me Tangere*** and ***El Filibusterismo*** be read and taught in all schools; **Section 4** clarifies it does **not** ban studying other heroes.





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Controversy stemmed from **two main points**:

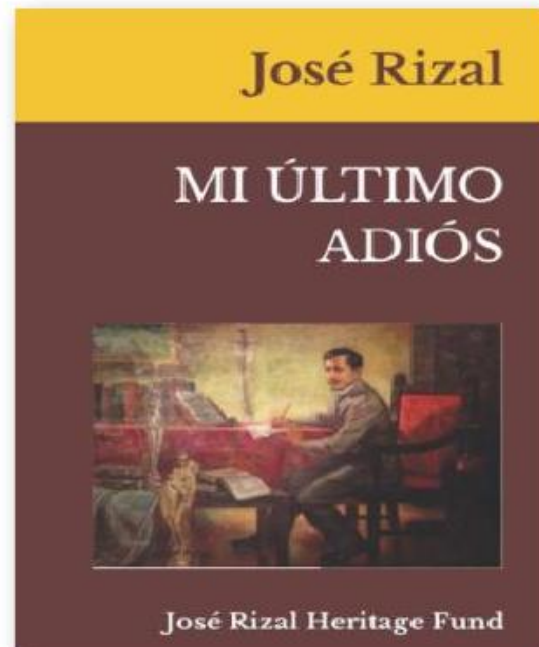
- (a) It **prioritized Rizal** over other national figures, which many saw as unfair bias.
- (b) In *Noli*, only **25 of 333 pages** focused on **nationalism**, while **290 pages criticized religion and clergy**, with more in *El Filibusterismo*.



Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Opposition to the bill was led largely by figures closely **connected to the Catholic Church**, who argued that mandatory reading of the novels violated freedom of conscience and religion under the **1935 Constitution**.

- They proposed teaching only selected works, such as **"Sa Aking mga Kababata"** or **"Mi Ultimo Adios"**, to focus purely on **Rizal's patriotism without religious conflict**.





CHURCH ST

STATE AVE



Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

- **Article II, Section 6** ("The separation of Church and State shall be inviolable"); and
- **Article III, Section 5 of the 1987 Constitution**, which prohibits laws **establishing religion and guarantees free exercise of faith.**

(a) Establishment Clause: No law may establish or promote a religion.

(b) Free Exercise Clause: Citizens may freely practice their faith without discrimination.

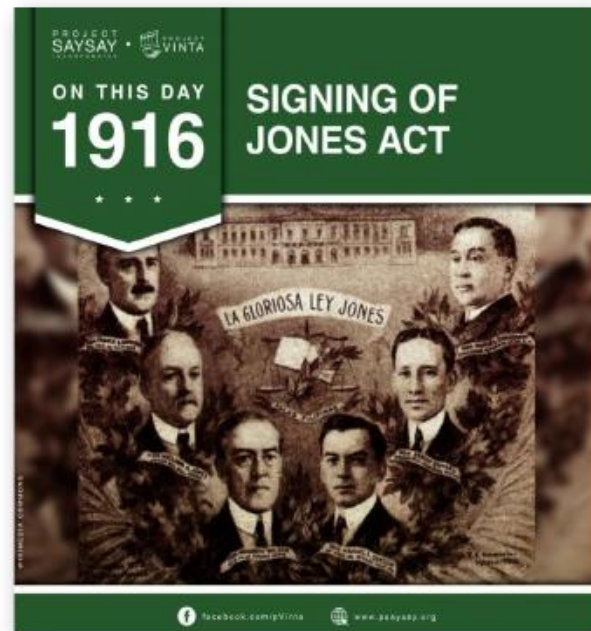


Jones Law (Philippine Autonomy Act of 2016 (In Context)

Authored by **U.S. Congressman William Atkinson Jones**. And also, it was signed by **President Woodrow Wilson** on August 29, 1916.

Key Provisions:

- Declared **U.S. intent to grant independence** once a **"stable government"** was established.
- Executive power **remained** with an American Governor-General.





Tydings-McDuffie Act of 1934 Independence (In Context)

Authored by **Senator Millard Tydings** and Representative **John McDuffie**. And also, it was signed by **President Franklin D. Roosevelt** on March 24, 1934.

Key Provisions:

- Created the Commonwealth of the Philippines (1935–1946) and **10-year transition**.
- Allowed Filipinos to **draft their own Constitution** (ratified in 1935); Independence **July 4, 1946**.



President Franklin D. Roosevelt signing the Tydings-McDuffie Act, March 24, 1934

#OnThisDay

March 24, 1934

The Tydings-McDuffie Act, known as the Philippine Independence Act, is approved by U.S. President Franklin D. Roosevelt. Under the Act, it established the process for the Philippines, to become an independent country after a ten-year transition period.

DIGITAL

@Bohol Provincial Library

Photo: Presidential Museum and Library

Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

The **HukBaLaHap:** formed as **anti-Japanese guerillas**, they were disrespected and disarmed by US forces after WWII.

- Denied seats in Congress following the 1946 election, they rebelled their movement lasted until **Luis Taruc surrendered in 1954** under **President Quirino and Defense Secretary Magsaysay.**
- Even then, the **belief that America still controlled the country never faded.**





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

American influence continued strongly after independence, shown through agreements like the **Bell Trade Act** (giving Americans equal rights to natural resources) and military pacts such as the **Mutual Defense Treaty (1951) and SEATO (1954)**.

- These **reinforced foreign control and fueled unrest like the Huk Rebellion**, which ended only after leader Luis Taruc surrendered in 1954, yet the sense of **true sovereignty remained fragile**.





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Senators Recto and Laurel pushed the Rizal Law to restore national pride and **identity amid this foreign dominance.**

- Laurel defended the mandatory reading of ***Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo***, stating these works act as a **"mirror"** for Filipinos revealing both strengths and flaws to build self-reliance, respect, and freedom.
- He argued that **religious concerns only arise if the novels** are taught without proper guidance.



Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

The law's main goal is to **plant nationalism and civic conscience in the youth**, rather than just focusing on past controversies.

Its value lies in understanding its purpose:

- To remind **Filipinos of the struggle** for independence and the meaning of true citizenship.

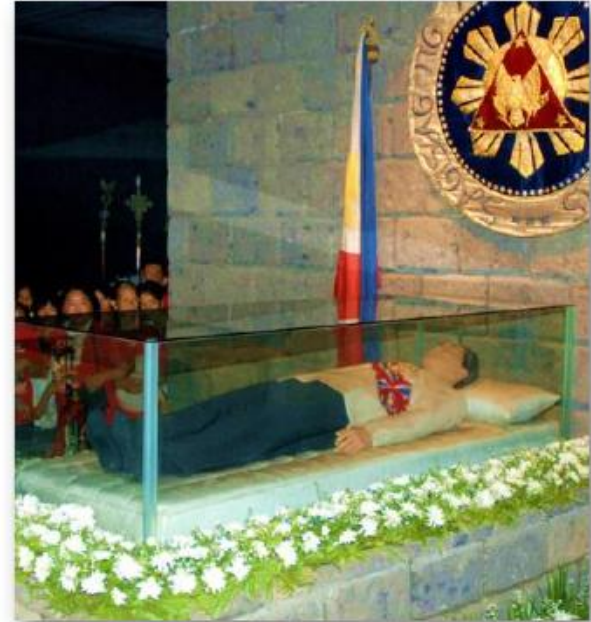


Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

The **Controversy of Selecting National Heroes**
Selection as a divisive issue comparable or even more controversial than debates over the Rizal Law

Case example: Ferdinand Marcos (2016)

- Event: Burial at the **Libingan ng mga Bayani**;
- Public reaction: **Widespread dissent and anger**; and
- Reason for opposition: **Perceived unworthiness** due to atrocities committed during his dictatorship.





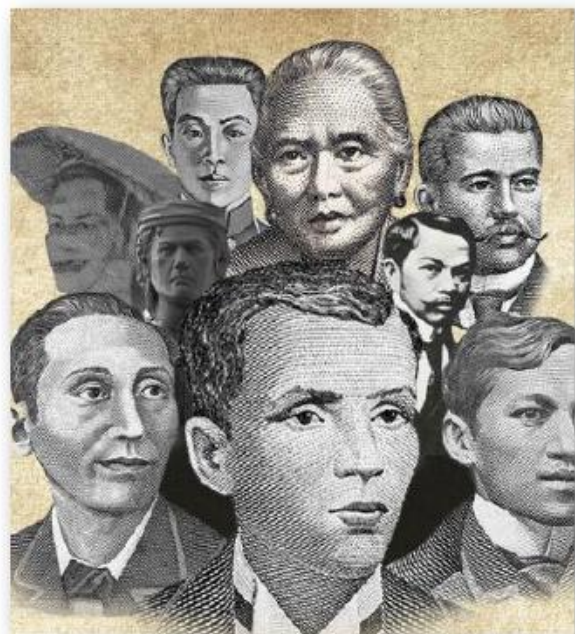
Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Debated Hero Status of Other Historical Figures

What **standard determines** who is acknowledged as a hero?

Contested figures:

- Ninoy Aquino: Some do not view him as a hero.
- Emilio Aguinaldo: Only **weak or uncertain** recognition of his heroism.
- José Rizal: Disputes exist; **some claim his status was created by the United States**, not earned naturally.





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Continued respect and impact

- **Andres Bonifacio** sent an emissary to **consult Rizal on plans for revolution.**

Rizal's death became a **turning point:**

It **shifted the goal of leaders** like **Apolinario Mabini** from seeking **assimilation to fighting for full independence.**





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Official acts of honor

- December 20, 1898: Emilio Aguinaldo declared December 30 **as Rizal Day and National Day of Mourning.**
- Act No. 345 (1902): Formalized December 30 as an annual national holiday.
- Act No. 317 (1901): Created the province of Rizal.
- Act No. 233 (1901): Authorized the building of the Rizal Monument at Luneta.
- Republic Act 229 (1948): Banned activities like cockfighting every December 30.





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

Official acts of honor

- Executive Order No. 429: Established the Rizal Pro Patria Award.
- Republic Act 1425: Mandated the study of his life and works.
- Naming of countless towns, streets, and landmarks nationwide.

Note: Formalization of Selection: **Executive Order No. 75 (1993)** issued by **President Fidel Ramos** to create an official process for declaring national heroes.





Lesson 1: Law, Literature and National Heroes (In Context)

National Heroes Committee.

- Membership: **(1)** Secretary of Education (Chair), **(2)** Secretary of Foreign Affairs, **(3)** Secretary of National Defense.
- Mandate: **Study, evaluate, and recommend individuals** to be formally recognized as national heroes.





TO BE CONTINUED ...





1. Rizal **didn't like Americans**

In a journal, he came across 'hambog' Americans who found everything in Paris bad. He glared at them, but *'hindi nakuha sa tingin.'*

Source: RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT, Ambeth Ocampo





Photo Source: Eagly Eye Charities Inc.

2. Rizal **was Insecure of his looks**

Asuncion Lopez-Bantug says that young Rizal was very conscious of how he looked since **he had a big head, a frail body, and was smaller than most kids his age.**

Source: RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT, Ambeth Gamboa

An illustration of a breakfast meal. At the top is a white cup filled with a thick, dark brown, bubbly liquid, likely hot chocolate. Below it, to the right, is a light-colored plate with two golden-brown, fried fish, identified as sardinas secas. The background of the illustration is white.

3. Rizal ate tuyo for breakfast

Rizal had a **cup of rice, hot chocolate, and sardinas secas (tuyo) for breakfast**. For lunch, he usually had rice and ayungin. When he was in Europe, he was too proud to admit to his landlady that he had no money for food.

Source: RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT, Ambeth Ocampo





Photo Source: Cariva

4. Rizal **was** *kuripot*

During a potluck dinner, Rizal was to bring champagne, but **he didn't want to supply the drinks for the party.**

So he told everyone he was not going to pay for the drinks and **asked them to pay their share, passing his hat around to collect the money.**

Source: RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT, Ambeth Ocampo





5. Rizal knew two Belgian sisters for 'amusement'

In Jose Alejandrino's memoirs, he said these sisters were '**palomas de bajo vuelo**' or '**kalapating mababa ang lipad.**' It is unclear whether this is the Jacoby girls or another pair of sisters.

Source: RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT, Ambeth Ocampo

Photo Source: Jose Rizal Online

6. Rizal **starts ghosting when things get too serious**

He ran away from:



Tottie Beckett
in London



Boustead
in Paris



Suzanne Jacoby
in Brussels

It might be because he wouldn't be able to **devote himself fully to the country.**

Source: RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT, Ambeth Ocampo

Photo Source: Jose Rizal Online



7. Rizal didn't get to take the exam to qualify for a doctorate

He had a Licentiate in Medicine, and **he was allowed to practice because he was a medical doctor.**

Source: RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT, Ambeth Ocampo

Photo Source: Eagle's Eye Charities Inc., Amazon



8. Paciano Rizal is the one who secretly sent Jose Rizal to Europe



This is because their mother **did not approve of a too-intelligent son, since if one knows too much, they will cut off your head.** Paciano advised Rizal and sent allowances.

Source: RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT, Ambeth Ocampo

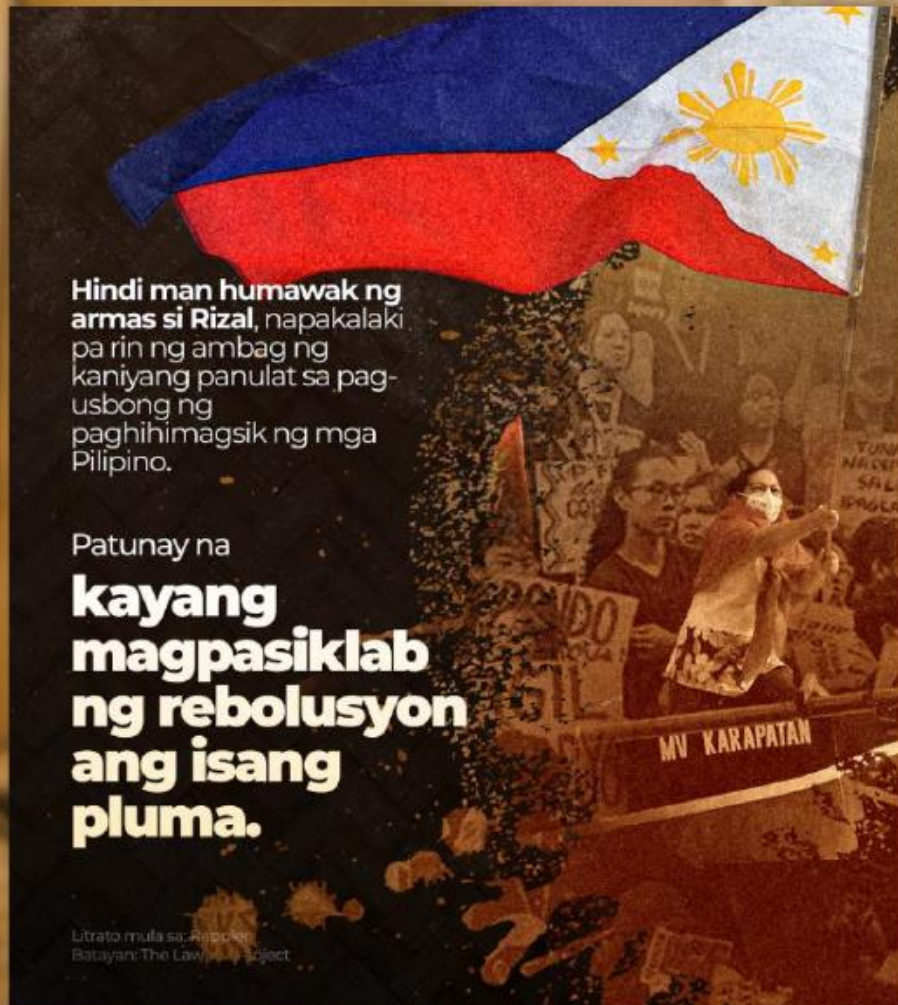
Photo Source: Wikipedia, Alchetron



**Hindi man humawak ng
armas si Rizal**, napakalaki
pa rin ng ambag ng
kaniyang panulat sa pag-
usbong ng
paghihimagsik ng mga
Pilipino.

Patunay na
**kayang
magpasiklab
ng rebolusyon
ang isang
pluma.**

Litrato mula sa: *Arbores*
Batayan: The Law Project





Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

It covers the **social structure, political conditions, educational system, and global events** of the time, while also challenging common assumptions and comparing **past realities with present progress.**

- **Purpose:** To ground Rizal's nationalism and provide a clear historical background of the Philippines in the 1800s.
- **Social Structure:** Explains social stratification, describing how society was divided into distinct classes and groups.





Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

- **Political Climate:** Analyzes the use and abuse of power under Spanish rule, uncovering the causes and realities of administrative corruption.
- **Educational System:** Evaluates both strengths and weaknesses noting that the system also brought positive developments, contrary to the view that Spain offered no benefits.
- **Global Context:** Links international events and ideas to the aspirations of Rizal and other *ilustrados* for national reform and progress.





Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

- **Broader Perspective:** Connects historical conditions to the meaning of patriotism, and contrasts the level of change and development between the 19th century and today.

It explains why this period matters: it is the era when Rizal lived, and more importantly, the time when true **Filipino nationalism emerged.**





Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

Different historians use different markers some start it in 1789 (French Revolution) or 1815 (Congress of Vienna); **1801-1900.**

- **Relevance of the Period:** It covers the lifetime of Rizal and marks the birth of Filipino nationalism.
- **Earlier Uprisings:** Revolts before the 19th century (e.g., Rajah Sulayman, Dagohoy, Tamblot, Bankaw) were limited driven by **personal grievances, local interests, or religious issues, not by a sense of nationhood.**





Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

- **Rise of True Nationalism:** The 19th century saw the first movement based on shared identity and collective welfare.
- **Root of Nationalist Sentiment:** It began with the hope for better living conditions and equal rights, not just the goal of independence; it was inspired by the experiences of Filipinos in Europe.





The MONARCH gave land to the tenants-in-chief, who paid rent in the form of continuing loyalty and military support.



The TENANTS-IN-CHIEF (lords and bishops):

- provided fully equipped knights to serve 40 days per year in the monarch's army
- provided the king with money, advice and prayers as appropriate.



The SUB-TENANTS (knights and lesser clergy) received land from the tenants-in-chief in return for:

- fighting wars for the king or praying for his success
- guarding and protecting the person and property of the chief tenant.



The sub-tenants allocated spare land to the PEASANTRY, who paid for the use of this land by:

- working the knight's or the lord's land as well as their own
- paying taxes in the form of crops.

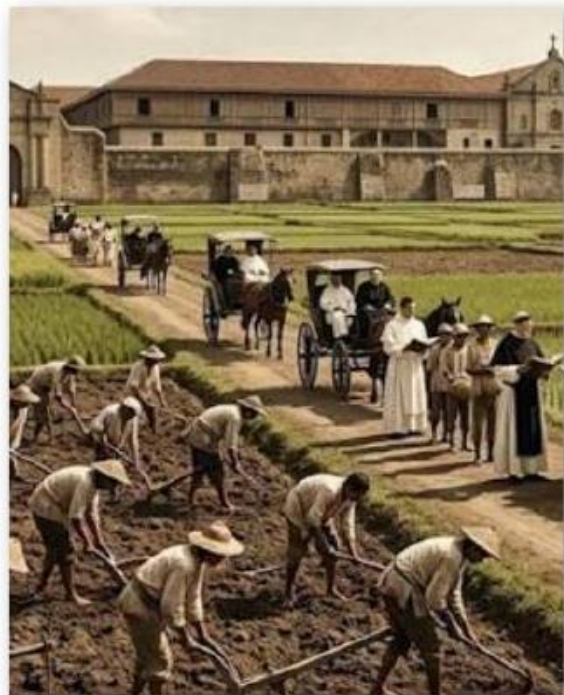


Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

- The root cause of this lack of progress was identified as the **feudal system** introduced by the Spaniards. Originally intended to **organize society and provide mutual protection**.

The system eventually became **exploitative**:

- Demands were **passed down from the highest landowners** to the lowest farmers, leaving the common **people or serfs burdened with heavy obligations**, little reward, and almost no protection.





Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

Spanish control lasted **236 years** (1565–1898), interrupted only by a short British occupation from 1762–1764.

- **Stagnation:** Unlike Europe, which advanced **technologically and economically**, the Philippines remained **"medieval" under Spanish rule**.

Note: The main barrier to progress was the **feudal system**, not just individual officials or friars.

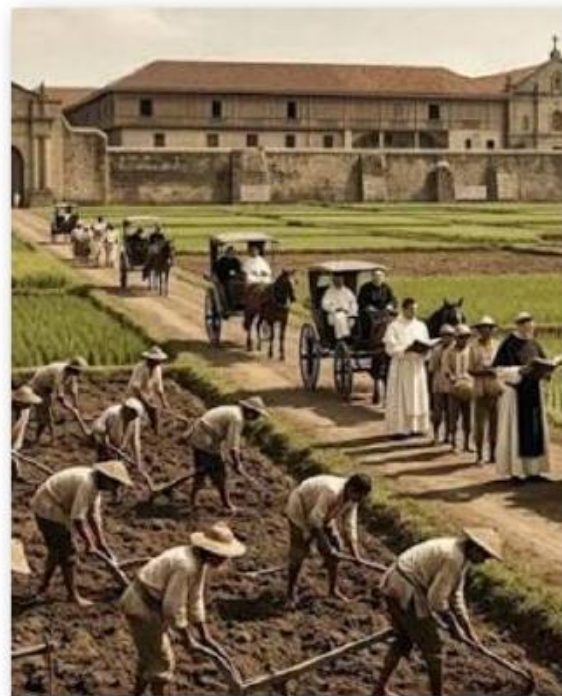




Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

Land was granted to **lords (seigneurs)**, who relied on vassals for service and protection; vassals then hired **commoners (serfs)** to farm the land.

- **Abuse of the System:** What began as a **fair arrangement** turned **oppressive excessive demands** were passed down the hierarchy, leaving serfs with insufficient food, shelter, and safety, and bearing the heaviest burden.



Colonial Order: Social and Political Hierarchies of the 19th-Century Philippines

The Political Ladder

National Executive:
The Governor-General and Church
The Governor-General held executive, judicial, and ecclesiastical powers, often influenced by the Archbishop.

Local Administration: Provinces to Barangays

Provincial:
Alcalde Mayor
Governance moved from Provincial Mayors down to the Cabeza de Barangay, responsible for tax collection.

City/Town:
Captain Municipal
Infrastructure development and serving as the local judge.

Barangay:
Cabeza de Barangay
Administration of 40-50 families and collection of tributes.



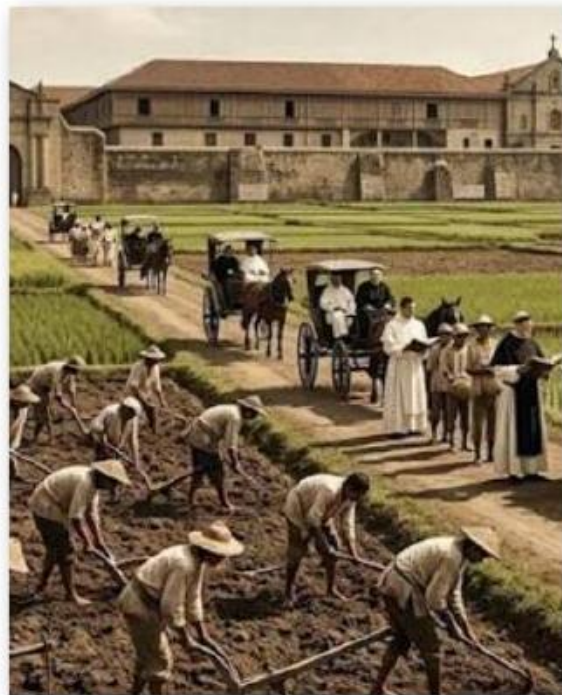


Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

French Revolution Reforms

- Abolished the **feudal system** on August 4, 1789.
- Removed **tax exemptions** for nobles and clergy, shifting the financial burden away from the poor.
- Made **punishment based on law**, not the will of those in power.

Note: Ended seigneurial dues and the **10% church tax (tithes)** paid only by commoners.



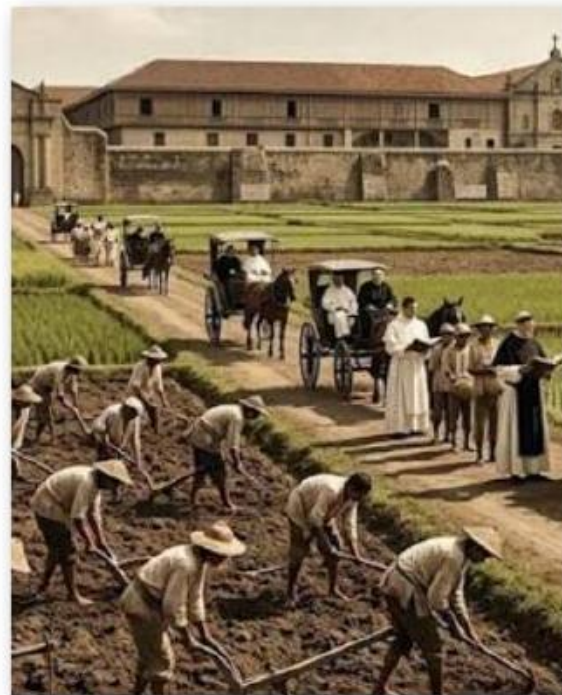


Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

Feudalism in Spain & Colonies

- Spain kept feudalism until the **Constitution of Cadiz (March 19, 1812)**.
- Remnants of the system **were brought** to the Philippines and remained dominant in the 19th century.

Note: Instead of helping ordinary people, it became the **main reason for the country's slow progress**.





Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

Top Tier Peninsulares: Spaniards born in Spain; held highest government and church positions.

Insulares / Creoles: Spaniards born in the Philippines; called “Spanish-Filipinos” then later simply “Filipinos”; faced discrimination from peninsulares, leading to resentment.





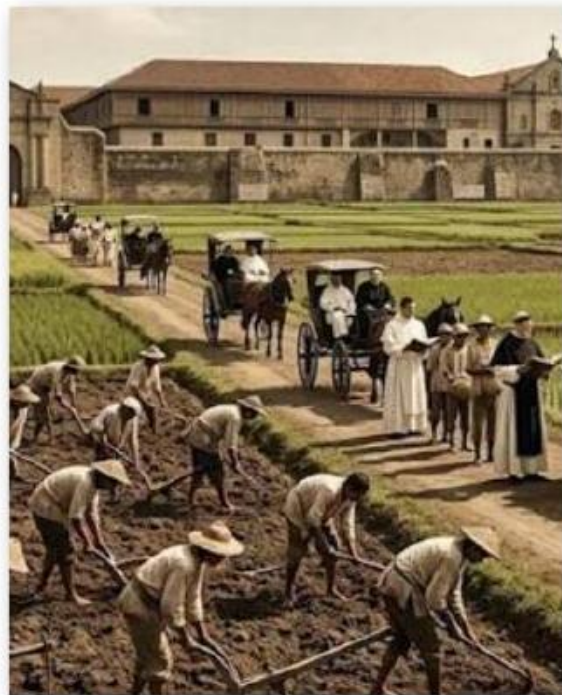
Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

Middle Tier Mestizos: Mixed-ancestry groups

- *Mestizo de Sangley*: Chinese descent.
- *Mestizo de Español*: Spanish descent.
- *Tornatras*: Mixed Spanish-Chinese (Rizal belonged to this group).

Ilustrados: “Enlightened” educated class; mostly mestizos and insulares; advocated for political and economic reforms (Rizal was one).

Principales: Descendants of pre-colonial leaders (datus, rajahs); held local posts; the Rizal family was part of this class.





Lesson 2: Streams and Ripples: The 19th Century (In Context)

Bottom Tier Indios: Native Malay/Indonesian inhabitants; originally the term “Filipino” did not apply to them; Rizal was also registered as *indio* by his grandfather.

Marginalized Groups: Muslims, highland tribes, and Aetas were excluded from mainstream society.

Basis of Division: Status depended heavily on ancestry and birthplace, creating inequality and class tensions.



Position or Social Class	Level of Government or Society	Key Responsibilities	Eligibility or Ancestry	Authority Type	Historical Context or Notable Individuals
Spanish Monarch (King or Queen)	Central Government	Highest civil authority; first patron or sponsor of evangelism.	Hereditary (Dynastic lineage).	Executive, Legislative, and Ecclesiastical	King Philip II, Carlos IV, Queen Isabela II, Alfonso XIII
Royal and Supreme Council of the Indies	Central Government	Territorial administration outside Spain; served as Court of Appeals; legislated the Laws of the Indies.	Appointed by the monarch; usually heads were priests or clerics.	Judicial and Legislative	Established by King Carlos V in 1524; abolished by Maria Christina in 1834
Viceroy of Nueva España	Central Government	Ruled Spanish territories in North/South America, Asia, and Oceania as King's representative.	Appointed by the King.	Executive	Francisco Ceinos (at time of 1565 colonization).
Ministerio de Ultramar (Ministry for Overseas Territories)	Central Government	Issued mandates toward remaining Spanish territories; reorganized local government.	Government department acting on behalf of the King.	Executive	Don Antonio Maura (established the Maura Law).
Captain General/ Governor-General	National Government	Direct administrator of the colony; promulgated decrees; President of Real Audiencia; Vice Patron of the colony.	Appointed by the King through the Viceroy as advised by the Council of the Indies.	Executive, Legislative, Judicial, and Ecclesiastical	Miguel Lopez de Legazpi, Carlos Maria de la Torre, Narciso Claveria, Ramon Blanco, Camilo Garcia de Polavieja
Archbishop/Bishop of Manila	National Government	Ruler of the local church; held spiritual authority over army and navy; great political influence.	Appointed by the King; usually friars.	Ecclesiastical and Political (Executive as Vice General)	Fray Domingo de Salazar, Bernardino Nozaleda, Manuel Rojo del Rio
Real Audiencia de Manila	National Government	Supreme Court of the colony; adviser to the Captain General; protected the indigents.	Composed of Oidores, Attorney-General (Fiscal), and a Constable.	Judicial and Advisory	Cristobal Tellez de Almanza, Simon de Anda

Position or Social Class	Level of Government or Society	Key Responsibilities	Eligibility or Ancestry	Authority Type	Historical Context or Notable Individuals
Cabo Segundo	National Government	Automatic successor to the Governor-General in case of death.	Inaugurated to refrain from controversy surrounding succession.	Executive	Title granted to Simon de Anda y Salazar as Lieutenant Governor.
Intendant General	National Government	Oversaw the conduct and whereabouts of officials.	Directly appointed by the King or Queen; held by the Bourbon of Spain.	Executive (Oversight)	Part of the Bourbon Reforms.
Alcalde Mayor (Provincia Mayor)	Local Government	Administered political territories (provinces) without conflict; tax collector.	Spanish officials appointed by the central administration.	Executive and Judicial	Held the 'indulto para komersyo' until the mid-19th century.
Corregidor	Local Government	Administrator and judge of provincial districts where threats of conflict remained.	Spanish official working under the Alcalde Mayor.	Executive and Judicial	Not in source
Gobernadorcillo	Local Government	Administrator of cities; later served under Captain Municipals.	Married principalia men; elective since 1768.	Executive and Judicial	Austin Craig mentioned abuses by these officials against indios.
Captain Municipal	Local Government	Ruler of municipal tribunal; built infrastructure; tax collection; served as judge.	Elected by a group of 13 voters (cabeza de barangays and former gobernadorcillos).	Executive and Judicial	Title established by the Maura Law; witnessed by Feodor Jagor.
Cabeza de Barangay	Local Government	Administrator of the barangay (40-50 families); collected tribute/taxes.	Initially the principalia; became elective in 1786; appointed by Governor General.	Executive	Qualifies for Captain Municipal after 3-year term.
Peninsulares	Top (Social)	Filled high government positions and clerical roles (friars).	Spaniards born in the Iberian Peninsula.	Executive and Ecclesiastical	Maintained rivalry with Insulares.
Insulares (Creoles)	Top (Social)	Clerical or government roles; later became the 'Filipinos'.	Spaniards born in the colonial islands (Philippines).	Executive or Ecclesiastical	Favored ilustrados and principalias due to grievances against peninsulares.

Position or Social Class	Level of Government or Society	Key Responsibilities	Eligibility or Ancestry	Authority Type	Historical Context or Notable Individuals
Mestizos	Middle (Social)	Trade and agriculture; influential in society and wealth.	Mixed origins: Sangley (Chinese), Espanyol (Spanish), or Tornatras (mixed Spanish/Chinese).	Socio-economic influence	Jose Rizal (Tornatra/Mestizo de Espanyol).
Ilustrados	Middle (Social)	Lobbied for political and economic reforms; intellectual leaders.	Educated few; mostly Mestizos de Espanyol or Insulares.	Intellectual/Political Influence	Jose Rizal; Propagandists.
Principalia	Middle (Social)	Local administration (Gobernadorcillos/Cabeza de Barangay); pre-colonial noble class.	Descendants of datos, rajahs, and lakans.	Administrative and Local Executive	The Rizal clan.
Indios (Indigents)	Lower (Social)	Bore the financial burden of taxes; worked the land.	Natives of the Philippines; descendants of Indonesians and Malays.	Subject to colonial rule	Juan Mercado (Rizal's grandfather) registered as Indio.



TO BE CONTINUED ...